ENGLISH STUDY NOTES

A practical guide to grammar, sentence building, vocabulary and confident everyday English

BEGINNER TO INTERMEDIATE

Parts of Speech • Tenses • Voice • Speech • Vocabulary

Examples · Practice Questions · Answer Key

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Study tip: Learn one topic at a time. Read the examples, make your own sentences, and attempt the practice questions before checking the answers.

1. Parts of Speech

Parts of speech describe the jobs words do in a sentence. The eight common categories are:

Part	Purpose	Examples
Noun	Names a person, place, thing or idea	student, city, book, kindness
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	I, you, she, they, it
Verb	Shows action or state	run, write, be, seem
Adjective	Describes a noun or pronoun	beautiful, tall, difficult
Adverb	Modifies a verb, adjective or adverb	quickly, very, often
Preposition	Shows relationship of time, place or direction	in, on, at, under, through
Conjunction	Connects words, phrases or clauses	and, but, because, although
Interjection	Expresses sudden emotion	Wow! Oh! Hurray!

See the parts in a sentence

“The clever student answered quickly, but he forgot his notebook.”

- **The** — article/determiner; **clever** — adjective; **student** — noun.
- **answered** — verb; **quickly** — adverb; **but** — conjunction.
- **he** — pronoun; **his** — possessive determiner; **notebook** — noun.

Note: Some school grammars treat articles (a, an, the) as a separate category; many modern grammars group them with determiners.

2. Basic English

A. Basic sentence structure

A sentence expresses a complete thought. A common pattern is **Subject + Verb + Object**.

Pattern	Example
Subject + Verb	Birds fly.
Subject + Verb + Object	Sara reads a book.
Subject + be + Complement	He is happy.
Subject + Verb + Place/Time	We study at home every evening.

B. Positive, negative and question forms

Type	Example
Positive	She likes tea.
Negative	She does not like tea.
Question	Does she like tea?
Past negative	They did not visit us.
Past question	Did they visit us?
With be	He is ready. / He is not ready. / Is he ready?

C. Useful everyday phrases

Situation	Useful English
Greeting	Hello! How are you? — I'm fine, thank you.
Request	Could you please help me?
Clarification	Could you repeat that, please?
Apology	I'm sorry for being late.
Opinion	I think this is a good idea.
Thanking	Thank you for your help.

Common error: After do/does/did, use the base verb: "Does he work?" and "Did they go?"

3. Tenses

Tenses help show when an action happens. V1 = base form, V2 = past form, V3 = past participle.

Tense	Structure	Example / Use
Present Simple	V1 / V1+s	She works daily. Habits and facts.
Present Continuous	am/is/are + V-ing	She is working now.
Present Perfect	has/have + V3	She has finished her work.
Present Perfect Continuous	has/have been + V-ing	She has been working for two hours.
Past Simple	V2	She worked yesterday.
Past Continuous	was/were + V-ing	She was working at 6 p.m.
Past Perfect	had + V3	She had left before I arrived.
Past Perfect Continuous	had been + V-ing	She had been waiting for an hour.
Future Simple	will + V1	She will call tomorrow.
Future Continuous	will be + V-ing	She will be working at noon.
Future Perfect	will have + V3	She will have finished by Friday.
Future Perfect Continuous	will have been + V-ing	By noon, she will have been working for three hours.

Negative and question patterns

- Present simple: He doesn’t play. / Does he play?
- Past simple: He didn’t play. / Did he play?
- Continuous: She isn’t reading. / Is she reading?
- Perfect: They haven’t arrived. / Have they arrived?

Important: Use the past participle (V3) after has, have and had. For example: “has gone,” not “has went.”

4. Active and Passive Voice

In the active voice, the subject does the action. In the passive voice, the subject receives the action. Passive structure: **be + past participle (V3)**.

Tense	Active	Passive
Present Simple	The chef cooks the meal.	The meal is cooked by the chef.
Past Simple	The chef cooked the meal.	The meal was cooked by the chef.
Present Continuous	The chef is cooking the meal.	The meal is being cooked by the chef.
Present Perfect	The chef has cooked the meal.	The meal has been cooked by the chef.
Future Simple	The chef will cook the meal.	The meal will be cooked by the chef.
Modal	They must finish the work.	The work must be finished.

Steps to change active into passive

- Move the active sentence's object to the subject position.
- Use the correct tense of "be" + V3.
- Add "by + doer" if the doer is important.

Example: Active — "The students cleaned the room." Passive — "The room was cleaned by the students." Verbs without an object (such as sleep) do not normally form a passive sentence.

5. Direct and Indirect Speech

Direct speech gives the exact words. Indirect (reported) speech reports the message without quoting the exact words.

Direct Speech	Indirect / Reported Speech
He said, “I am tired.”	He said (that) he was tired.
Mina said, “I have finished.”	Mina said (that) she had finished.
He said, “I will call you.”	He said (that) he would call me.
She said, “I can swim.”	She said (that) she could swim.
Ali asked, “Where do you live?”	Ali asked where I lived.
She asked, “Are you ready?”	She asked if/whether I was ready.
The teacher said, “Sit down.”	The teacher told us to sit down.

Common tense and time changes

Direct form	Reported form (often)
am/is →	was
are →	were
have/has done →	had done
will →	would
can →	could
today / tomorrow / yesterday	that day / the next day / the day before
this / here	that / there, depending on context

For questions, use statement word order after the reporting phrase: “She asked where I lived,” not “She asked where did I live.” Tense backshift is not always necessary when a statement remains true.

6. English Vocabulary

A. Word families

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
success	succeed	successful	successfully
decision	decide	decisive	decisively
beauty	beautify	beautiful	beautifully
care	care	careful / careless	carefully / carelessly
creation	create	creative	creatively

B. Commonly confused words

Words	Meaning / example
their / there / they’re	their = belongs to them; there = place; they’re = they are
your / you’re	your = belongs to you; you’re = you are
its / it’s	its = belonging to it; it’s = it is / it has
than / then	than = comparison; then = time or order
advice / advise	advice = noun; advise = verb
lose / loose	lose = fail to keep; loose = not tight
affect / effect	affect is usually a verb; effect is usually a noun

C. Useful collocations

- **make** a decision; **make** a mistake; **make** progress.
- **do** homework; **do** your best; **do** exercise.
- **take** a break; **take** notes; **take** responsibility.
- **heavy** rain; **strong** coffee; **deep** sleep.

D. Vocabulary-building tips

- Write a new word with its meaning and one original sentence.
- Learn common word partners, not just single words.
- Review words regularly and use them in speaking or writing.

7. Practice Questions

Attempt all questions before looking at the answer key.

A. Choose the correct answer

- 1. A word that names a person, place or thing is a (noun / verb).
- 2. She (go / goes) to school every day.
- 3. They (was / were) playing football.
- 4. I have lived here (since / for) 2021.
- 5. He bought (a / an) orange.
- 6. Did you (see / saw) the film?
- 7. The room (cleaned / was cleaned) yesterday.
- 8. Sara said, “I am happy.” → Sara said she (is / was) happy.
- 9. “They're” means (their / they are).
- 10. You should (study / studied) every day.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 11. He don't like coffee.
- 12. Did she went home?
- 13. The work completed by Ali yesterday. (Make it passive correctly.)
- 14. He asked me where did I live.
- 15. I need an advice.

C. Transform the sentences

- 16. Active to passive: The workers repaired the road.
- 17. Direct to indirect: Sara said, “I am busy.”
- 18. Make negative: He plays cricket.
- 19. Make a question: They have finished the task.
- 20. Write one sentence using the word “successful.”

8. Answers

A. Choose the correct answer

1. noun
2. goes
3. were
4. since
5. an
6. see
7. was cleaned
8. was
9. they are
10. study

B. Correct the mistakes

11. He **doesn’t** like coffee.
12. Did she **go** home?
13. The work **was completed** by Ali yesterday.
14. He asked me where **I lived**.
15. I need **some advice**. / I need **a piece of advice**.

C. Sample answers

16. The road was repaired by the workers.
17. Sara said (that) she was busy.
18. He does not play cricket.
19. Have they finished the task?
20. Sample: “She was successful because she worked hard.”

Keep practising: read English daily, write your own examples, and review any mistakes you make. Small, regular practice leads to steady improvement.

End of English Study Notes